

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; hydration; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; bean-shaped

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm shows paired kidneys with medial indentations, central vessels, and ureters. Those cues distinguish an anatomical kidney from a food bean at small sizes. Vendors may simplify detail or use a single kidney if the organ remains recognizable.

The example images are original vector artwork created for this proposal and released under CC0 1.0. Editable SVG sources and the license are included in the public packet:

<https://github.com/ShuhanCS/medicalemoji/tree/feat/microsoft-round-strategy/submissions/v1.2.0/kidney/images>

<https://github.com/ShuhanCS/medicalemoji/blob/feat/microsoft-round-strategy/submissions/v1.2.0/ARTWORK-LICENSE.md>

Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple usages

Kidney is a familiar body part with uses across anatomy, health, education, donation, food, and shape. It supports ordinary conversations about hydration, urine, kidney function, kidney stones, laboratory results, dialysis, transplant, living donation, school science, and family health. The name also appears outside medicine in kidney beans and kidney-shaped objects. The image remains specifically anatomical, while the concept has broad linguistic reach.

Kidneys are commonly understood as the body's filters. That association gives the emoji uses in simple explanations of filtration, fluid balance, waste removal, and medication safety without requiring specialist terminology. It also supplies a direct visual reference for kidney donors, recipients, caregivers, and clinicians, where a bean, droplet, hospital, or pill does not identify the organ.

B. Use in sequences

Kidney can combine with existing emoji to create messages without standardized sequences:

- Kidney + droplet: hydration, urine production, or filtration.
- Kidney + warning: kidney stone, abnormal result, or urgent kidney concern.
- Kidney + hospital or pill: kidney care, dialysis, treatment, or medication review.
- Kidney + people or heart: donation, transplant, recipient, caregiver, or support.
- Kidney + book or microscope: anatomy, school science, or laboratory testing.
- Kidney + bean or cooking pot: kidney beans or food context.

C. Breaks new ground

No current emoji represents the kidneys or urinary-system anatomy. A bean primarily represents food; a droplet is ambiguous among water, sweat, tears, blood, and urine; and hospital, pill, and syringe represent places or interventions rather than the organ. Kidney would therefore add a distinct internal-organ concept and enable messages that cannot be expressed clearly with existing emoji.

D. Distinctiveness

The paired form, bean-shaped outer contours, medial indentations, and downward ureters make the proposed paradigm visually distinct from the single bean emoji and from anatomical heart, lungs, and brain. The 18x18 versions preserve the paired silhouette and central connection. Color is helpful but not required: the black-and-white example remains identifiable by structure.

E. Expected usage level

The required evidence covers general web results, video results, long-term web interest, image-search interest, and published-book usage. Google Trends and Google Books compare kidney with Unicode's reference term elephant .

Evidence	Result in included capture	Reproducible URL
Google Search	About 211,000,000 results; captured 2026-05-13	https://www.google.com/search?q=kidney&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Video Search	About 66,000,000 results; captured 2026-05-13	https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=kidney&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Trends Web Search	Worldwide, 2004-present; kidney is of the same order as elephant and rises to comparable or greater recent interest; captured 2026-05-13	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=elephant,kidney
Google Trends Image Search	Worldwide, 2008-present; sustained kidney image-search interest; captured 2026-05-13	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=elephant,kidney
Google Books Ngram Viewer	English, 1500-2022; kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage; captured 2026-07-09	https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Ckidney&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3

Google Search

Google

kidney

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AI Mode All Images Videos Shopping News Short videos More Tools

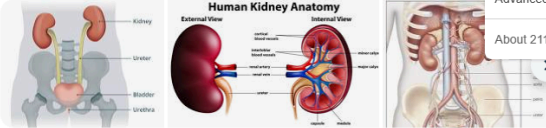
AI Overview

Any time

All results

Advanced Search

About 211,000,000 results (0.16s)



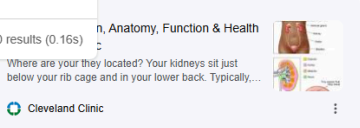
Human Kidney Anatomy

Kidneys are **two bean-shaped organs, about the size of a fist, located on either side of the spine just below the rib cage**. They filter roughly 37 gallons of blood daily to remove waste and extra water, maintaining fluid, salt, and mineral balance while producing urine. Key functions also include regulating blood pressure, stimulating red blood cell production, and managing bone health. [Cleveland Clinic](#) +4

Key Kidney Functions & Health

- Filtration:** Using millions of tiny units called nephrons, kidneys filter waste and excess water from the blood, which then travels to the bladder through ureters.

[Show more](#)



Kidneys: Location, Anatomy, Function & Health

Where are they located? Your kidneys sit just below your rib cage and in your lower back. Typically...

[Cleveland Clinic](#)

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease At-a-Glance. Image. 1 in 3 adults in the U.S. are at risk for kidney disease. Image. 90K people...

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra wat...

[National Institutes of Health \(gov\)](#)

 Cleveland Clinic

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/body/21824-kidney>

Kidneys: Location, Anatomy, Function & Health

Nov 5, 2025 — Your kidneys are organs that filter your blood. They remove waste and balance your body's fluids, among other tasks. Most people have one kidney ... [Read more](#)



People also ask

What are the first signs of a kidney problem?

What is the best drink to flush your kidneys?

What are the three early warning signs of a kidney?

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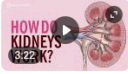
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How Do Kidneys Work?



For more information about the function of kidneys, please see https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3 Your kidneys are your body's cle...
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch

Get to Know Your Kidneys



Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ...
YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch

Kidney Function



KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ...
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025

www.youtube.com › watch

How Your Kidneys Work



MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall.
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024

www.mayoclinic.org › multimedia › vid-20207497

How kidneys work



How kidneys work — Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine.
Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021

www.youtube.com › watch

Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease



Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ...
YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021

Any duration

Any time

Any quality

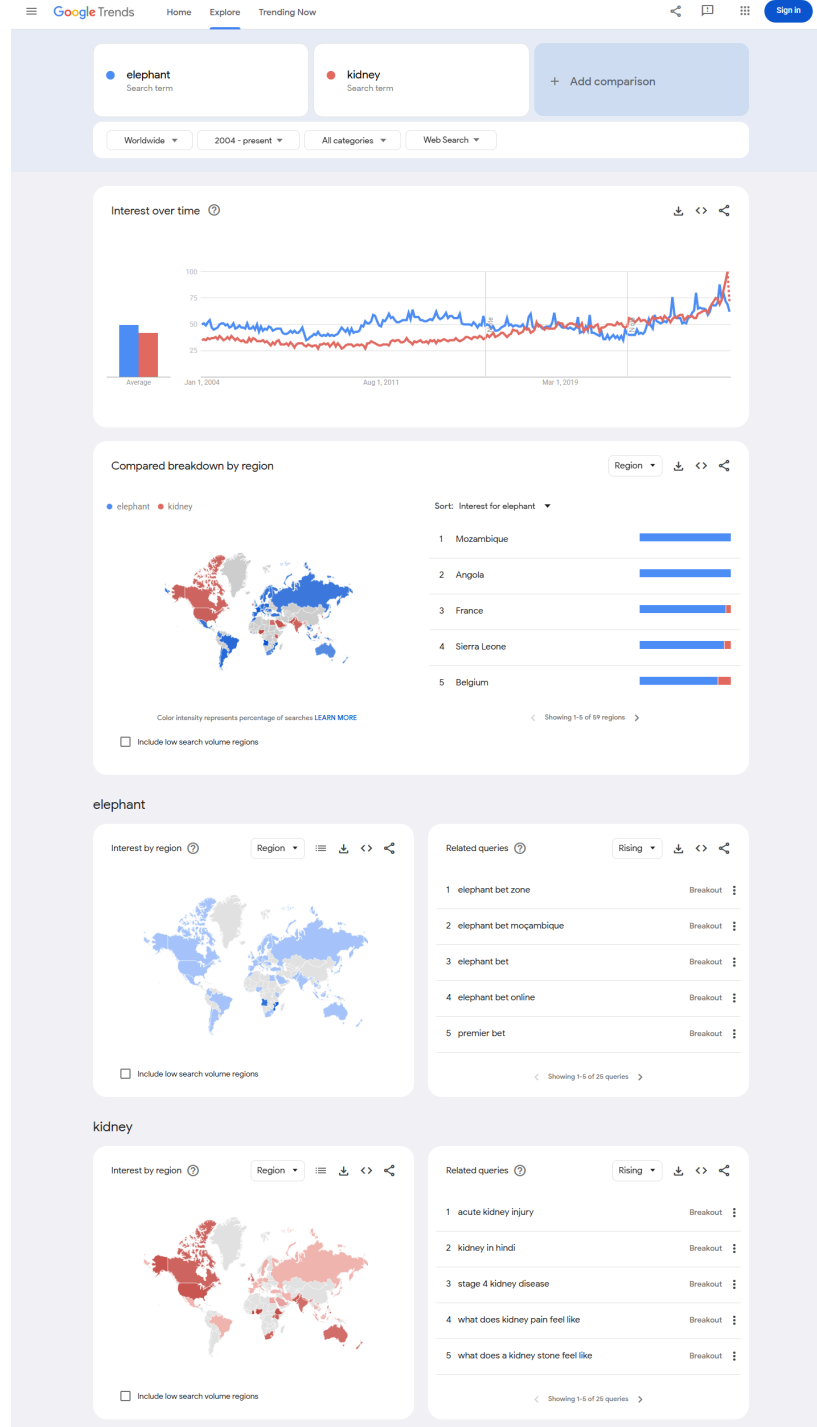
All videos

Any source

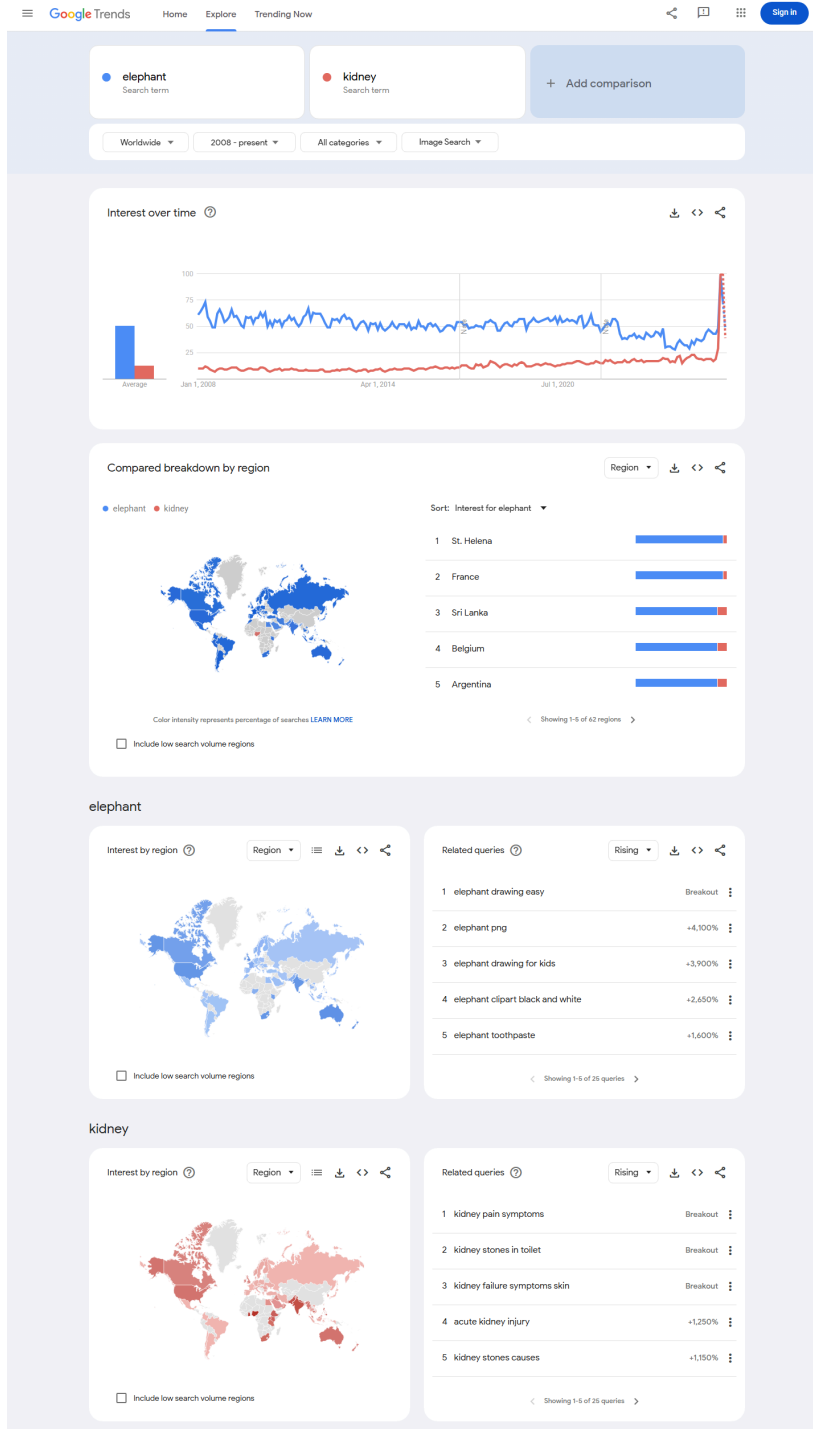
Advanced Search

About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)

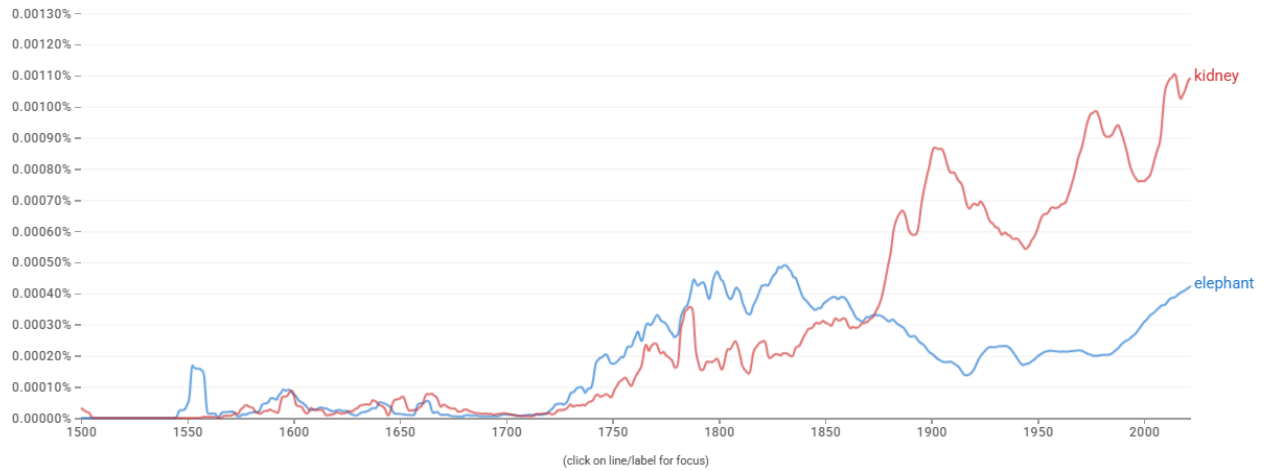
Google Trends - Web Search



Google Trends - Image Search



Google Books Ngram Viewer



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Kidney is independently useful and is not proposed merely to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already represented

Kidney is not represented by an existing emoji. Bean cannot serve as a clear substitute in anatomical, donation, transplant, dialysis, testing, or medication contexts. General medical emoji identify care but not the organ.

B. Overly specific

Kidney is a primary organ and a broad everyday concept, not a particular disease, procedure, specialty, organization, campaign, or brand. Its uses span body anatomy, health, filtration, hydration, stones, donation, transplant, food language, and education.

C. Open-ended

This proposal does not request a complete anatomy taxonomy. Kidney is supported by its own frequency, multiple usages, visual distinctiveness, and lack of an adequate substitute. Other organs

can be judged independently on the same criteria.

D. Transient

Kidney anatomy, hydration, stones, disease, dialysis, transplant, donation, and kidney-shaped language are durable concepts rather than a temporary event or trend.

E. Justified only by existing emoji

The proposal does not argue that kidney should be encoded merely because heart, lungs, or brain exist. Those emoji only demonstrate that anatomical organs can be legible at emoji scale. Kidney's case rests on its own expected usage and expressive gap.

Other Information

The singular name `kidney` is concise and searchable even though the paradigm depicts a pair. Essential design cues are a clearly organic form, a medial indentation, and enough paired or urinary-system context to avoid reading as a food bean. Fine vascular detail is optional and should yield to legibility at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>